

01

Source-complete coverage ledger and answer-worthiness labels

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

[FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Logical/evidential formulations, Plantinga, Augustine, Hick, process theodicy, karma and direct PYQ routes are CORE PAPER II.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The ledger records where each source is retained rather than claiming completeness without mapping it.

ANSWER LINE: [FACT] identifies retained repository doctrine or verified question data. [INFERENCE] identifies learner-facing organisation or judgement.

02

Current scholarly anchor — [SUPPORTING, NOT DOCTRINAL AUTHORITY]

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

□ Fact: A Winter 2025 Philosophia Christi symposium, publicly described on 13 March 2026, examined new directions in skeptical theism, CORNEA, the amount of evil and excessive-skepticism objections.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The audited Paper II corpus contains 7 primary-owned questions, one in every year from 2019 through 2025 and none in 2018.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

□□ Inference for answers: These publications show that the live debate has shifted beyond the bare logical triad toward evidential weighting and the epistemic cost of skeptical replies.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

They are a contemporary anchor, not proof of any position.

ANSWER LINE: □ Fact: A Winter 2025 Philosophia Christi symposium, publicly described on 13 March 2026, examined new directions in skeptical theism, CORNEA, the amount of evil and excessive-skepticism objections.

03

Session 1 - Conceptual Method: What Problem Is Being Asked?

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Major criticism: The problem of evil is not one argument but a family of challenges generated by the relation among a divine profile, the facts of suffering and wrongdoing, and norms governing what a good agent would permit.

03

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Logical, evidential, existential and protest taxonomy

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

04

Session 2 - Classical Formulation and Mackie's Logical Problem

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Major criticism: The familiar questions - whether God is willing but unable, able but unwilling, or both able and willing while evil exists - are commonly labelled the Epicurean paradox.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The dilemma is transmitted in later discussion, prominently through Lactantius, and Hume's Dialogues Concerning Natural Religion gives a celebrated modern formulation through Philo.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore, if such a God exists, evil should not exist.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The exact popular wording should not be presented as a verbatim quotation from Epicurus.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

05

Session 3 - Plantinga's Free Will Defence

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Major reply: The defence is strongest for moral evil.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

If so, God's inability to actualize freedom-with-guaranteed-goodness is not lack of omnipotence, because the proposed object is not a feasible world God can strongly actualize.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

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MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Therefore God's existence is logically compatible with moral evil.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

If God causally determines every significantly free choice to be right, the choice is not libertarianly free in relation to God.

ANSWER LINE: **ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

06

Session 4 - Evidential Evil: Rowe, Probability and Skeptical Theism

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Evidential force depends on a noseum move: "We see no justifying reason; therefore there probably is none." Such reasoning is strong when observers would likely detect the relevant reason if it existed, as when looking for an elephant in a small room.

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

The case is illustrative, not a claim that one event alone deductively disproves God.

ANSWER LINE: **ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM**

07

Session 5 - Classical Theodicies and Defences

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Major reply: Created being is good insofar as it has being; evil is not a positive substance made by God but a privation, corruption or disorder of a due good.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Hick contrasts a soul-making world with a hedonistic paradise that continuously adjusts to desire.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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Session 6 - Non-Classical Theisms and Revised Divine Attributes

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Whitehead is the metaphysical source; Hartshorne argues against classical omnipotence; David Ray Griffin develops process theodicy; John Cobb systematizes process theology.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Process, finite, open and Molinist revisions

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

[THESIS] Process thought does not preserve classical unilateral omnipotence.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Session 7 - Existential Evil, Protest and Horrendous Evils

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Recommended opening definition: Existential approaches ask not only whether a proposition is coherent but what stance is humanly and morally possible before suffering.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Dostoevsky's Ivan Karamazov refuses a final harmony purchased through innocent suffering.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

!Existential protest and anti-theodicy

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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10

Session 8 - Indian and Non-Western Frameworks

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

High-value transition: Karma (morally consequential action) is structurally strong on distribution but morally dangerous when converted into retrospective certainty about a victim.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Recommended opening definition: Indian traditions do not share one answer because they disagree about creator, self, world, karma (morally consequential action) and liberation.

CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

[ARGUMENT] Action produces a causal potency or karmic consequence; continuity across lives widens the field in which consequences mature; present suffering may therefore be connected to prior agency; liberation ends bondage or the production of future consequences.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

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ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

11

Session 9 - Hard Cases and Meta-Level Critiques

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

High-value transition: Animal suffering is a central evidential challenge because predation, disease, parasitism and extinction precede human agency and often seem unrelated to moral growth.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

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UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Stable-law and evolutionary accounts explain mechanisms and goods such as complex life, but not obviously the intensity and duration of sentient pain.

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12

Session 10 - Comparative Synthesis and Practical Implications

CONTEXT + EXACT CORE

Final verdict: Comparison is strongest when each position is judged through the same axes of ultimate reality, world relation, human relation, causation and religious function.

MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

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CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

High-value transition: Theodicies should be compared through the divine attribute revised, the evil explained, the residual case and the moral cost of the explanation.

UPSC TRAP / ANSWER USE

Add one Indian comparison that changes the frame rather than decorating the answer.

ANSWER LINE: ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM